MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN LOAF, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-C-44061A, dated 30 September 1983, and is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

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3.2.1, line 3: Delete "120" and substitute "75"

3.2.1.1(a), (b), (c) and (d): Delete and substitute:

"a. Bone-in or boneless chicken received in the fresh chilled state may be held for up to 4 days prior to processing, provided that the temperature of the chicken does not exceed 40°F, during the holding period.

b. Fresh chilled bone-in chicken may be frozen and held for a period not to exceed 75 days from date of initial acceptance provided that the chicken is placed in the freezer within 4 hours after acceptance and frozen to 0°F within 72 hours, and that the chicken is packaged to protect it from freezer deterioration or other damage. The temperature of the chicken shall not exceed 0°F during the holding period.

c. Frozen chicken shall not show any signs of thawing or refreezing."

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3.3.1(c), line 2, after "skins.": Add the following:

"Alternatively, rolls can be made from either all white or all dark meat provided that the percentages specified in 3.3.1(b) are met in the end item.

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3.3.1(d): Delete and substitute:

"(d)" The chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dice settings at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch."

3.3.1.1(a), line 3: Delete "8" and substitute "24".

3.3.1.1(a), end of line 4: Add the following new sentences:

"Alternatively, the cooked meat may be held in the frozen state for not more than 30 days provided that the meat is vacuum packaged into gas and moisture impermeable bags or mechanically stuffed (to exclude air pockets) into impermeable casings and secured at both ends with metal clips or by heat sealing. The packaging shall be of flexible material impermeable to water and have an oxygen permeability of not more than 10cc of oxygen per 24 hours per mil thickness at 72°F and 0 percent relative humidity. The oxygen and moisture permeability factors shall be certified by the packaging material manufacturer and such certification shall be supplied to the responsible USDA-AMS inspection agent for each shipment."

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3.4: Add the following:

"1. Product shall contain discernible dices."

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Table II, footnote 2, line 4: Delete "agent" and substitute "Poultry Graders"

4.5.6 and 4.5.6.1: Delete and substitute:

"4.5.6 Product testing.

4.5.6.1 Fat content testing. The product shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Fosslet Method or the Crude Fat or Ether Extract Method (using petroleum ether) in the Meat and Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to

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the fat content requirement in 3.4 shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0."

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4.5.6.2: Delete and substitute:

"4.5.6.2 Salt content testing. The product shall be tested for salt content in accordance with the Meat Section in the Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the salt content requirement in 3.4 shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0."

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6.3, line 2: Delete "DAR 7-104.55" and substitute "FAR 52.209".

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B011

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